

# 3 of Spades

*Kadi ni Tiri — A team-based trick-taking card game*

|                  |                                              |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Players          | 6 or 8                                       |
| Deck             | Standard 52-card, 2s removed (48 cards)      |
| Round length     | 8 tricks (6 players) or 6 tricks (8 players) |
| Points per round | 250                                          |
| Goal             | Reach the target score set by the host       |

## Game Overview

3 of Spades is a strategic trick-taking card game for 6 or 8 players. Each round, players bid for the right to choose hidden teammates and declare the trump suit. The highest bidder commits to capturing at least that many points during the round. Teams shift every round, identities stay hidden, and the game ends when any player reaches the host's target score.

## Card Values

Only 22 of the 48 cards are worth points. Everything totals to exactly **250 points** per round.

| Card                            | Points each | Count         | Subtotal   |
|---------------------------------|-------------|---------------|------------|
| 3 of Spades                     | 30          | 1             | 30         |
| All 5s                          | 5           | 4             | 20         |
| 10s, Jacks, Queens, Kings, Aces | 10          | 20            | 200        |
| All other cards                 | 0           | 23            | 0          |
|                                 |             | <b>Total:</b> | <b>250</b> |

*Note: **3 of Spades** is the namesake card — worth more than any other single card and often a focal point of bidding strategy.*

## Setup

- The host creates a room and shares the room code with friends.
- The host sets a **target score** in the lobby — the score that, once reached, ends the game.
- Once 6 or 8 players have joined, the host clicks **Start Game**.
- All 48 cards are shuffled and dealt evenly: 8 cards per player (6-player game) or 6 cards per player (8-player game).

## A Round, at a Glance

|                         |                                                                                      |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1. Deal</b>          | Cards dealt face-down. Each player sees only their own hand.                         |
| <b>2. Bidding</b>       | Players bid for the right to choose teammates and trump suit.                        |
| <b>3. Pick Team</b>     | Winning bidder selects hidden teammates by naming specific cards.                    |
| <b>4. Declare Trump</b> | Bidder picks the trump suit (Spades, Hearts, Diamonds, or Clubs).                    |
| <b>5. Play Tricks</b>   | Players play cards across multiple tricks. Winning team accumulates captured points. |
| <b>6. Score</b>         | Round-end scoring &mdash; one team scores, the other gets zero.                      |

## Phase 1: Bidding

Players take turns deciding whether to bid or pass. A bid is a promise: if you win the bidding, you must capture **at least that many points** for your team during the round, or your team loses.

### Rules

- Minimum opening bid: **30 points**. Bids go up in increments of 5.
- Each new bid must be **strictly higher** than the current highest bid.
- If you've been outbid, you can bid again at any time before passing.
- If you pass, you are out of the auction for this round.
- If you are the current highest bidder, you cannot pass. You can either let others bid or close the bidding manually if you're confident.
- Bidding ends when every player except the highest bidder has passed, OR when someone bids the maximum of 250.
- If everyone passes without a single bid, the round is voided — no scoring, redeal.

### Strategy

Look at your hand before bidding. Strong hands include many high cards (10s through Aces), lots of one suit (useful as trumps), or the **3 of Spades** itself. Remember that you alone won't capture all the points — your two or three hidden teammates will help. Bid conservatively if your hand is weak; bid aggressively if it's loaded.

## Phase 2: Pick Teammates

After winning the bid, you secretly choose your teammates by naming specific cards. Whoever is holding the named card joins your team — but no one is told who.

| Total Players | Cards You Pick | Your Team Size |
|---------------|----------------|----------------|
| 6 players     | 2 cards        | 3 (you + 2)    |
| 8 players     | 3 cards        | 4 (you + 3)    |

- You may pick any card from the 48-card deck — including cards in your own hand.
- If you pick a card from someone else's hand, they secretly join your team. They learn this privately; opponents don't.
- If you pick one of your own cards, that pick is “wasted” on you — you stay on the team alone for that slot. Your team will be smaller than normal.
- Teammates' identities stay hidden until round end (or until clever play reveals them).
- At round end, full team rosters are revealed alongside the scores.

***Tip:** Picking high-point cards (Aces, Kings, the 3 of Spades) recruits players who are already likely to capture points. But beware — experienced opponents may watch which cards you name and infer your strategy.*

***Self-pick strategy — solo for the glory:** If you're very confident in your hand, you can pick your own cards instead of recruiting partners. The risk is huge: you face the rest of the table almost alone, and if you fall short of the bid, the opposing team pockets those points. But the reward is just as big — **you are the only one credited with the score**, instead of splitting credit with two or three partners. High risk, high*

reward.

**Self-pick strategy — the bluff:** *Even if you don't intend to go solo, picking one of your own cards mixed in with real teammate picks confuses opponents. They can't be sure whether that card is "at" another player or at you. Useful when you want to disguise your team composition.*

## Phase 3: Declare Trump

After teams are formed, the bidder names one suit as **trump** for the round. Trump cards beat all cards of other suits, regardless of rank.

- Within the trump suit, higher rank wins. Within any non-trump suit, higher rank wins only if no trump was played.
- Card rank order (low to high): 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, J, Q, K, A.
- Pick a trump suit where you and your suspected teammates are strong. If you held the 3 of Spades and several spades, declare Spades — the 3 of Spades is worth 30 points.

## Phase 4: Playing Tricks

Players take turns playing one card from their hand. The collection of cards played in one go-around is called a **trick**, and the player who plays the highest card wins it — sweeping all the cards into their pile.

### Following suit

- The bidder leads the first trick. The winner of each trick leads the next.
- If you have a card of the suit that was led, you **must** play it. (You can play any card of that suit — high or low.)
- If you have no cards of the led suit, you may play any card — including a trump or any other suit.

### Who wins a trick?

- If any trumps were played: the highest trump card wins.
- If no trumps were played: the highest card of the **led suit** wins. Off-suit non-trumps cannot win, regardless of how high they are.
- Example: Hearts led, no trumps played. A 5 of Hearts beats a Queen of Diamonds, because Diamonds didn't follow the led suit.

### Winning trick = winning points

The captured cards' point values are added to that player's team total. The round is over after all 8 tricks (6-player game) or 6 tricks (8-player game). Total points captured across both teams will always add up to 250.

## Phase 5: Scoring

Round-end scoring is symmetric: **one team scores the full bid amount**, the other team scores zero. Captured points decide which team wins the round, but the score on the board is always the bid.

| Outcome                               | Score effect                                                 |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Bidder's team captured $\geq$ the bid | Bidder's team scores the bid amount; opponents score 0.      |
| Bidder's team captured $<$ the bid    | Opposing team scores the bid amount; bidder's team scores 0. |

***Example:** Bidder bids 80. Their team captures 95 of the 250 points. Result: bidder's team scores 80 points (each player). Opponents score 0. Even though the bidder's team captured more than 80, they don't get a bonus.*

***Example:** Bidder bids 120. Their team captures only 90. Result: opponents score 120 (each player). Bidder's team scores 0.*

## Ending the Game

The game continues round after round until one of two things happens:

### Target reached

The host sets a target score in the lobby (e.g. 500). At the end of any round, if any player's total score has reached or exceeded the target, the game ends immediately. The player(s) with the highest score win.

## Player leaves the room

The game requires exactly 6 or 8 players, so if anyone leaves (or disconnects) while a game is in progress, the game ends immediately. Remaining players are shown the final standings as they stood at the moment of departure.

## Ties

If two or more players are tied for the highest score when the game ends, they are all declared **joint winners**. The Game Over screen shows every tied player's name in gold.

## After the game

From the Game Over screen, the host can click **Back to Lobby** to return everyone to the room with scores reset to zero (the target score is preserved, so the host can adjust it for a rematch). Any player can leave the room entirely.

# Strategy Tips

### Bidding

Count your power cards before bidding. Each Ace, King, Queen, Jack, and 10 is worth 10 points. The 3 of Spades alone is worth 30. A hand with two Aces, a Ace-King, and the 3 of Spades is already a ~70-point hand — combined with two hidden teammates, comfortably worth bidding 100+.

### Picking teammates

If your hand is light on a suit, name a high card from that suit — you'll likely recruit someone who can cover your weakness. Picking the 3 of Spades is high reward but high information leakage: opponents now know one of your team holds it.

### Trump selection

Declare a suit where you hold many low cards and at least one high card. Low trumps are surprisingly powerful — they beat any non-trump regardless of rank.

### Trick play

If you have no chance of winning a trick, dump your lowest-value card (a 4, 6, 7, 8, or 9). Save your point cards for tricks your team is likely to win. Watch the cards being played to deduce who your teammates are.

# Quick Reference Card

*Tear this off or pin it where everyone can see it. Everything you need to play.*

## Card Values

|                  |             |
|------------------|-------------|
| 3 of Spades      | 30 pts      |
| Any 5            | 5 pts       |
| 10, J, Q, K, A   | 10 pts each |
| 3, 4, 6, 7, 8, 9 | 0 pts       |

## Rank order (low → high)

3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, J, Q, K, A

## Trick rules

- Must follow suit if you can.
- Highest trump wins.
- No trump played → highest card of the led suit wins.
- Off-suit non-trumps can never win.

## Round result

- Bidder's team captures  $\geq$  bid → they score the bid.
- Bidder's team captures  $<$  bid → opponents score the bid.
- Losing side scores 0 either way.

## Game ends when:

- Any player reaches the host-set target score, OR
- A player leaves the room mid-game.
- Highest score wins. Ties → all tied players win jointly.
- Host can return to lobby for a rematch (target preserved).

Three of Spades / Kadi ni Tiri — ACOP290 team project  
Saket Sharma, Parva Tejas Chaudhary, Mohammed Taqi Ahsan, Aditya Mohan